

RDC Aging-in-Place Technology & Medical Alert Planning Guide

A decision workbook for choosing technology based on the actual problem to solve - not the gadget someone is trying to sell.

Start with function. Technology should support a clear need, fit the person's habits and abilities, and have a backup plan when batteries, internet, cellular service, or people fail.

1 | WHAT PROBLEM ARE WE TRYING TO SOLVE?

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	Ability to call for help after a fall or emergency	
☐	Fall detection when a button may not be pressed	
☐	Protection outside the home / GPS location	
☐	Medication reminders or organization	
☐	Family check-ins / communication	
☐	Door or entry awareness	
☐	Smoke / CO / environmental alerts	
☐	Caregiver coordination	
☐	Hearing / vision accessibility	
☐	Power-outage communication	
☐	Other: _____	

2 | USER FIT

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	The person will actually wear or carry the device.	
☐	Buttons / screen / volume are usable with current vision, hearing, hand strength, and dexterity.	
☐	Charging routine is realistic.	
☐	The device works in the places where help may be needed - bedroom, bathroom, yard, vehicle, community.	
☐	The person understands what happens after an alert.	
☐	False alarms can be cancelled or handled without creating confusion.	

Check	Item	Notes / status
[]	A family member can help with setup, updates, troubleshooting, and replacement.	

3 | MEDICAL ALERT / EMERGENCY RESPONSE COMPARISON

Feature	Option A	Option B	Option C
Works in home			
Works away from home			
Cellular included			
Landline required			
GPS location			
Automatic fall detection			
Two-way voice			
Water resistance / shower use			
Caregiver app / notifications			
Battery life			
Monitoring center response			
Home-access plan / lockbox support			
Monthly cost			
Contract / cancellation			

4 | RELIABILITY & BACKUP

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	Device is tested on the schedule recommended by its provider.	
☐	Charging / battery replacement responsibility is assigned.	
☐	Family knows whether the device depends on cellular, Wi-Fi, landline, Bluetooth, or a smartphone.	
☐	There is another way to summon help if the device is unavailable.	
☐	Emergency contact information is current.	
☐	Monitoring / alert recipients know what action they are expected to take.	
☐	Home-entry plan works if the resident cannot reach the door.	
☐	Power-outage plan accounts for device charging and communication.	

5 | PRIVACY & ACCEPTANCE

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	The older adult understands what data the device collects.	
☐	Camera / sensor use matches the household's privacy expectations.	
☐	Family agrees who can view alerts, location, or activity information.	
☐	Technology is not being used as a substitute for needed hands-on care.	
☐	The person knows how to turn off or remove nonessential features they do not want.	

6 | OUR DECISION

Primary problem to solve	
Best-fit technology	
Why it fits	
Who will set it up	
Who receives alerts	
Backup plan if it fails	
Date to re-evaluate	

RDC can help families think through fit and readiness. Device availability, pricing, features, cellular coverage, and monitoring terms should be confirmed directly with the provider.